Your First 90 Days: The $2,000+ Roadmap

Plasma Pay Calculator — plasmapaycalculator.com

Week 0: Prep Week (Before Your First Visit)

- **Research centers** within 30 miles — compare BioLife, CSL, Grifols, Octapharma
- **Check new donor bonuses** — most offer $700-$1,000 for first month
- **Get your documents ready:** Valid photo ID, proof of address, Social Security card
- **Hydrate aggressively** for 3 days before — 80+ oz water daily
- **Eat iron-rich foods** — red meat, spinach, beans, fortified cereal
- **Download the center's app** — BioLife, CSL, etc. for scheduling

Ideal Weekly Donation Schedule

Day	Activity	Expected Pay
Monday	Donation #1	$50-75
Tuesday	Recovery Day	—
Wednesday	Recovery / Hydrate	—
Thursday	Donation #2	$50-75
Friday-Sunday	Recovery & Meal Prep	—

Week-by-Week Plan

Weeks 1-2: Foundation ($200-400)

- Complete first 4 donations at your primary center
- Start tracking every visit in the Donation Tracker spreadsheet
- Note wait times, staff quality, overall experience
- Take the new donor bonus — typically highest payout

Weeks 3-4: Optimize ($400-700 cumulative)

- Dial in your pre-donation routine (hydration, iron, protein)
- Visit a 2nd center for their new donor bonus
- Start tracking mileage for tax deductions
- Ask about referral bonuses — bring a friend for $50-100 bonus

Weeks 5-8: Scale ($800-1,400 cumulative)

- Lock in a consistent schedule at your highest-paying center
- Stack loyalty bonuses on top of base pay
- Check the Center Pay Rate Bible for better rates nearby
- Optimize for weight tier (higher weight = higher pay)

Weeks 9-12: Maximize ($1,400-2,000+ cumulative)

- You're now a regular — faster process, shorter waits
- Stack monthly bonuses + referral bonuses
- File quarterly estimated taxes with your tax deductions
- Consider rotating centers for overlapping promotions

> **Pro Tip:** New donor bonuses are the single biggest income boost. Some donors visit 3-4 different centers in their first 90 days, stacking $2,000-3,000 in bonuses alone.

What to Bring Every Visit

- Photo ID (must match center records)
- Water bottle (32 oz minimum)
- High-protein snack for after
- Phone with charger or headphones
- Warm layers (donation rooms are cold)
- Stress ball (helps speed up donation)